

Skills Summary

Comparing Groups of Objects: More, Fewer, and the Same

Use this reference while completing your worksheet or when studying.

Skill 1 — Which Group Has More, Fewer, or the Same?

The model: put the two groups in two rows, one object under one object.

- The row that **runs out first** has **fewer**.
- The row with **leftovers** has **more**.
- If **nothing** is left over in either row, the groups are **the same**.

The notation: the symbol opens its mouth toward the bigger number. $8 > 5$ says “8 is more than 5”; $5 < 8$ says “5 is fewer than 8”; $4 = 4$ says “4 is the same as 4”.

Example: One row has 8 buttons. The other row has 5 beads.

Step 1. The question is which group is bigger, so match the rows one to one instead of guessing by how long the rows look.

Step 2. Five buttons find a bead. Three buttons are left over, so the buttons are more, and the comparison is written $8 > 5$.

Try it: A shelf holds 4 books. A box holds 7 blocks. Write $>$, $<$, or $=$ between 4 and 7.

check: $4 < 7$

Skill 2 — How Many More? How Many Fewer?

Rule: “how many more” and “how many fewer” ask for the *leftover* part — the objects with no partner — not for the whole row.

The notation: bigger number – smaller number = how many more. The same subtraction answers both questions, because “Ana has 3 more” and “Ben has 3 fewer” describe the same picture.

Example: There are 8 cars and 3 drivers. How many more cars than drivers?

Step 1. The question asks for the extra cars, so I match a driver to a car and look only at the cars left without one.

Step 2. Three cars get a driver. Counting the cars still empty gives 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, and the sentence $8 - 3 = 5$ records it.

Try it: A tray holds 10 cookies and 6 napkins. How many more cookies than napkins?

check: 4

Skill 3 — Making Two Groups the Same

Rule: to make the smaller group match the bigger one, add exactly as many objects as there are leftovers in the bigger row.

The notation: smaller + ____ = bigger. Count **up** from the smaller number to the bigger one; every count you say is one object you still have to add. Then check by adding.

Example: Rosa has 3 stickers. Theo has 7. How many more does Rosa need?

Step 1. Rosa's row is shorter, so the missing objects are the ones under Theo's leftovers — that makes this an add-to-match question, not a take-away one.

Step 2. Count up from 3 to 7: “4, 5, 6, 7” is 4 counts. Check: $3 + 4 = 7$ ✓, so Rosa needs 4 more.

Try it: Mia has 2 marbles. Kai has 8. How many more does Mia need?

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(!) **Watch out:** a longer-*looking* row is not always the bigger group — objects spread far apart still have to be counted or matched. And “how many more” never means add the two numbers together: it asks only for the leftovers.